Case Study: The "Urgent Verification" Phishing Scam

Definition of the Crime Phishing is a type of cybercrime where an attacker masquerades as a trusted entity (like a bank, a university, or a company like **Deloitte**) to trick victims into revealing sensitive data. This data typically includes usernames, passwords, credit card numbers, or UPI PINs.

The Step-by-Step Process

1. **The Bait:** The attacker sends a mass email or SMS (Smishing) that appears to be from a legitimate source, such as the university's IT department or a popular banking app.
2. **The Hook:** The message creates a sense of "false urgency," claiming that the user's account will be suspended or that a suspicious transaction of ₹50,000 has occurred unless they "verify" their details immediately.
3. **The Trap:** The victim clicks a link in the email that leads to a "spoofed" website. This site is designed to look exactly like the real login page of the bank or college portal.
4. **The Theft:** When the victim enters their credentials (like their password), the attacker captures them in real-time.

5. **The Payoff:** The attacker uses these credentials to drain bank accounts, steal identity data, or sell the information on the dark web.

Target Audience College students and elderly individuals are primary targets. Students are often targeted through "Student Grant" or "Placement Drive" scams because they are eager for opportunities and may not yet be trained to spot sophisticated digital fakes.

Consequences The consequences are severe, ranging from immediate financial loss to long-term **Identity Theft**. For a student, a compromised academic account can lead to leaked personal records, unauthorized access to assignments, and a damaged digital reputation that is difficult to repair.